The examination is being carried out on the **following application documents**

Description, Pages

1-69 filed with entry into the regional phase before the EPO

Claims, Numbers

1-13 filed with entry into the regional phase before the EPO

Drawings, Sheets

1/10-10/10 filed with entry into the regional phase before the EPO

Reference is made to the following documents; the numbering will be adhered to in the rest of the procedure.

D1 EP 1 670 069 A1 (MATSUSHITA ELECTRIC IND CO LTD [JP]) 14 June 2006 (2006-06-14)

D2 DE 10 2011 002340 A1 (HELLA KGAA HUECK & CO [DE]) 31 October 2012 (2012-10-31)

D3 US 2007/030676 A1 (ICHIHARA JUN [JP]) 8 February 2007 (2007-02-08)

Clarity (Article 84 EPC)

1 The application does not meet the requirements of Article 84 EPC, because:

1.1 Claim 1 is not clear: The wording of claim 1 seems to miss some determining information to clarify the matter for wich protection is sought. For example:

- In the expression "wherein a first virtual straight line passing through a center of a circle formed by the first convex portion at a first point where the first light source is in contact with the virtual curve and a second virtual straight line passing through a center of a circle formed by the second convex portion at a second point where the second light source is in contact with the virtual curve is parallel to each other", the mentioned circles are not clear. None of the first and the second convex portions has been defined as a circle. Thereto, the relationship between the first or the second point and the first or the second virtual straight line is not clear.
- In the expression "wherein an angle between a first tangent line contacting the

virtual curve at the first point and the first straight line includes a first obtuse angle", it is not clear if the tangent is tangent to the circle introduced above or to the virtual curve.

1.2 Claims 2 and 3 are not consistent: The the feature "wherein each of the light sources includes a light emitting device" seems to be redundant in claim 3.

1.3 Claim 3: In the expression "wherein a plurality of straight lines passes through each of the plurality of light emitting devices and **(the?)** center of virtual circles formed by each of the plurality of convex portions", it seems that a term like "the" is missing as highlighted.

1.4 Similar remark is applicable to claims following claims, in particular see claims 4, 11 and 12.

Novelty/Inventive step (Art. 54.56 EPC)

2 It seems that the subject-matter of independent claim 1 is not known from the available prior art. The examining division might consider to propose the granting of a patent based on the claims on file once the application fulfils all the requirements of the EPC. Therefore, in order to facilitate the proposal of a granting:

2.1 The applicant is invited to amend the claims taking account of the aforementioned comments.

2.2 When filing amended claims the applicant should also indicate how the subject-matter of the independent claim differs from the state of the art and the significance thereof and **expose the argumentation about the inventive step within the meaning of Article 56 EPC in terms of problem-solution approach.**

2.3 The applicant should bring the description into conformity with the claims and delete or amend any statements or expressions which throw doubt on the scope of protection (GL F-IV, 4.3). Failure to do so could lead to the refusal of the application under Article 97(2) EPC in combination with Article 84 EPC. Care should be taken during revision, especially of the introductory portion and of any statements of problem or advantage, not to add subject-matter which extends beyond the content of the application as originally filed (Article 123(2) EPC).

2.4 The independent claim should be drafted in the two-part form, whereby the features known from the prior art should be placed in the preamble in accordance with Rule 43(1) EPC.

2.5 To meet the requirements of Rule 42(1)(b) EPC, the state of the art documents should be identified in the description and the relevant background art disclosed therein should be briefly discussed. In addition, the applicant should ensure that it is clear from the description which features of the subject-matter of the amended independent claim is already known from this document.

2.6 The features of the claims should be provided with reference signs placed in parentheses to increase the intelligibility of the claims (Rule 43(7) EPC). This applies to both the preamble and characterising portion (see Guidelines C-III, 4.19).

2.7 In order to facilitate the examination of the conformity of the amended application with the requirements of Article 123(2) EPC, the applicant should clearly identify the amendments made, irrespective of whether they concern amendments by addition, replacement or deletion, and indicate the passages of the application as filed on which these amendments are based (see Guidelines E-II, 1).